



Search Engines

How many times have you been on the verge of going crazy hunting for sites on a particular topic? Or nearly torn your hair out exasperated with search results that were exactly the opposite of what you were looking for? Powerful search engines help us navigate through the maze of information in cyberspace avoiding dead ends or dead links. Comprehensive Web direc-

tories build huge repositories of Web sites categorised into different sections that are a ready reference point. All you need to do is browse through and you'll find what you're looking for. The search engines listed here bring you the best of the Indian Web with the least effort. They are your 'compass', helping you navigate through the tangled web of online information.

THE ABSOLUTE WINNER JUDGES CHOICE & POPULAR CHOICE



The India Directory in Khoj has a great selection of indigenous sites

Khoj, part of the Sify network of sites, packs in a Web search powered by Google, a Web page search for Indian sites and a news headlines search which searches news headlines from Sify. The results are fairly accurate.

But Khoj is best known for its Web directory service. It has two comprehensive Web directories. The India directory is well categorised and has a good selection of Indian sites. The categories cover government, sports, science, engineering, veterinary science, and online communities of Indians, to name a few. There's a brief description of the site with a link that opens up in another window, ensuring that you don't lose track of where you started out. The world directory has a large number of sites categorised alphabetically and subject-wise. If you're simply browsing around and not looking for anything in particular, check out the site's 'what's hot' keywords to update yourself on what's new and happening and what everyone else is looking for.

'Ask Sify' question search is another great way to look for informa-

tion and sites. This directory has more than 10,000 questions for which you'll find the answers here. You can either ask Sify a question or browse through sites category-wise. Khoj also has links to the Open Directory Project at www.dmoz.org.

Top of the Web (% votes)	
Khoj	42
123india	31
Searchindia	13
Appuonline	7
Bharathseek	7

www.searchindia.com

Searchindia is a good search engine for locating Indian sites. Although, the homepage has only a search box with a couple of links, don't let that fool you. This site has a Web directory that carries some neat sites and it offers easy navigation that helps you ferret out the best sites you want. You can choose to search through the Web directory using the keyword search or browse by category. The site also has a city guide, a directory of hotels in India and weather forecast for Indian cities.

www.123india.com

The search feature at 123india has a simple keyword search. The advanced search option lets you define how you want the keyword to be matched and offers case sensitivity too. You can browse through the Web sites in the directory either by category or use the directory search—a feature that lets you search for Web sites through the directory or even within a particular category. If you want to find the latest Indian sites, all you have to do is head for 'What's New' at 123india.com.

THE OTHER NOMINEES

www.bharathseek.com

This site contains a search service and a Web Directory. Bharathseek search is a keyword search, but its Web directory is pretty good, covering a variety of categories from entertainment and culture to science and society. These categories contain a fairly large number of sites (but Indian only) and Web pages. You can also use the search box to search through the Web directory. The site has news, weather as well as links to other sites on music, e-greetings and forums.

www.appuonline.com

Appuonline is one of the best online guides to Indian sites. The keyword search throws up search results containing sites that are both Indian and non-Indian. Appuonline's Web directory is its best feature, providing links and descriptions of the Web pages. Another good feature of the site is its categorisation of Web pages from the directory all through the site in a manner so as to suit a particular interest (such as shopping or travel) or a certain section of the population (women, children and so on).

